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NOW WHAT?

What happens when the world loses its biggest factory overnight?

“Breaking News”, screamed every TV channel to people above 35 who were watching. And everyone under 35 saw the same two words screamed at them on every social media channel of their choosing. And no, this wasn’t the usual click-baiting of “breaking news” being how cute a celeb couple’s new baby is... this was big! China had gone incommunicado, and had essentially closed their factories to everyone outside of its borders.

Why it happened is unimportant. What is important to understand is what happens now?

Most of us will never get to experience the violence with which vacuums are filled. It’s something the astronauts on the space station fear greatly indeed. Instead, here on our rich atmosphere planet, we are more used to the effects of an explosion blasting outwards. Both are essentially a violent end to a pressure differential, as equilibrium is sought by the system. China going on strike would cause something similar to occur around us. And that’s bad, because explosions and implosions are uncontrolled, and can lead to...

UNFORESEEN CONSEQUENCES

We’ve all seen how difficult it can be when people go on strike, and if it is one of the essential services on strike, we’re bound to suffer. So what happens when a factory that produces for the whole world goes on strike? Mayhem! It’s the western countries that are most reliant on that factory, but not exclu-